

Daniel Rickey

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud architecture and Linux systems professional with technical depth spanning networking, virtualization, cybersecurity, and infrastructure engineering. Brings hands-on experience designing AWS-hosted environments, managing DNS and web hosting services, and building AI-driven automation workflows. Returned to full-time cloud work in 2026 after pandemic career progression disruption, channeling the setback into personal growth experience of operational leadership. Personal R&D, documented in the Technical Development Path below, now forming the technical foundation of San Diego Cloud Solutions, the company founded to deliver it.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, Route 53, SES, API Gateway, CloudFront, Lambda), Linux Server Administration, Web Hosting, DNS Management, Server Hardening, Virtualization

Networking: TCP/IP, Routing & Switching, Wireless Networking, Cisco Technologies, IP Networking, Network Segmentation

Programming & Automation: Python, BASH, AI Workflow Automation, AI-Assisted Automation

Security & Databases: Cybersecurity Fundamentals, Linux Hardening, Web Server Security, MySQL Administration

Technical Support: Hardware Troubleshooting, Software Support, Audio/Visual Systems, Customer-Facing Technical Service

Certifications In Progress: Claude Certified Architect - Foundations (CCA-F, Expected: August 2026) | CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701, Expected: September 2026) | AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C03, Expected: November 2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

San Diego Cloud Solutions

2026 – Present

Founder & Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

- Building and operating San Diego Cloud Solutions, developing SanDiegoAI.HELP as a market-ready AI automation platform targeting local San Diego businesses
- Designing and deploying production AWS infrastructure (EC2, S3, Route 53, Lambda, SES) supporting live web hosting, custom domain email, and AI-powered service delivery
- Architecting and administering DNS configuration, domain registration management, and security controls across client-facing applications and AWS services
- Developing AI automation workflows to reduce manual operational overhead and to deliver intelligent customer communication pipelines as a commercial service offering
- Evaluating and integrating emerging cloud and AI technologies to define and expand a scalable managed services portfolio
- Designing an AI-powered conversational intake system (ai-audit-interview) to qualify prospective clients for sandiegoai.help services, connecting to existing Lambda/API Gateway infrastructure and feeding directly into the Lead Leak Audit and Practice Gap Audit service pipeline

Vons Companies, Inc.

2022 – 2025

Grocery Supervisor

- Managed inventory systems and operational data for \$100K+ in daily product volume, applying process discipline and data-driven decision making to minimize loss and maintain accuracy
- Led and developed a team in a high-throughput environment, establishing procedures, productivity benchmarks, and compliance standards
- Trusted as designated key holder responsible for critical access controls and opening/closing operations

Harmony Home Medical, Inc.**2022***Repair & Installation Technician*

- Diagnosed and repaired electromechanical mobility equipment including power wheelchairs and scooters, applying systematic troubleshooting methodology
- Installed accessibility systems at residential and commercial sites, coordinating scheduling and providing direct customer technical support

Mitac, Inc.**2021***Audio/Video Production Engineer*

- Configured and deployed full A/V infrastructure for a corporate hybrid live/video-conference sales event, integrating IP networking with A/V-over-IP systems
- Operated and monitored live A/V systems throughout the event, ensuring uninterrupted broadcast and in-room experience

Illumanonymous, LLC**2019 – 2021***Cloud Infrastructure Consultant*

- Designed and deployed AWS-based infrastructure supporting business applications, web services, and custom email solutions across multiple client domains
- Managed DNS configuration and domain lifecycle for a portfolio of internet domains, ensuring uptime and routing reliability

TECHNICAL DEVELOPMENT PATH

The R&D foundation behind San Diego Cloud Solutions and San Diego AI HELP, current AI-assisted architecture and infrastructure work, grown out of earlier virtualization and systems experience below.

AI Foundations Lab**2026 – Present**

- Actively developing a browser-based AI literacy course platform under San Diego Cloud Solutions, with a named AI instructor persona (Sage) guiding students through a structured module-unlock curriculum
- Architected a hybrid delivery model with a live Sage chat interface, platform-side artifact storage, student accounts, and a dual-mode design supporting both browser-based and local (Claude Desktop) learning tracks
- Curriculum and instructor vision documented in VISION.md, INSTRUCTOR-VISION.md, and SAGE.md; course content structured in outline.md — real deliverables in active development, not a future concept
- A companion platform fork (ai-course-platform) is in founding stage, designed to extend the model for broader deployment

Devlog Engine**2026 – Present**

- Engineering a local-first activity-logging system in Python, migrating structured development logs from a flat-file Markdown prototype into a queryable MySQL database
- Running the flat-file version through real development sessions first to surface schema requirements from actual usage rather than designing the database speculatively
- Building a standardized write-script interface so any project, current or future, logs activity through one consistent path instead of bespoke per-project logging

AI Development Architecture**2026 – Present**

- Designing and actively refining a three-layer architecture for coordinating multiple AI coding agents across simultaneous projects: a single orchestrating instance, isolated per-project agent instances, and a shared activity layer connecting them
- Iterating the architecture in real time as new projects come online, using each addition to test and reshape the coordination model rather than treating it as a fixed spec

- Operating under a staged automation model (manual → prompted → drafted → autonomous) as a governing constraint on the system, deliberately preventing premature automation as agent capability scales
- Building to support development of San Diego AI HELP, now extending into a project-dashboard coordination layer providing a unified visual view across all active projects, and showing potential as a standalone product or service offering

Portable Cloud Architecture

2024 – Present

- Operating a portable, self-managed infrastructure environment supporting web hosting, software development, AI experimentation, and remote access services, modeled on the previously engineered Linux-based multi-role virtualization platform in a mobile form factor
- Running isolated experimental and testing VMs alongside primary development work, with VM-level sandboxing protecting the host system during hands-on learning and configuration changes
- Serves as the operating environment for the AI Development Architecture above, running Claude Code instances as continuous development partners for production work, with workflows and tooling under constant iteration and optimization as a standing practice

Multi-Role Virtualization Platform

2021 – 2023

- Designed and deployed a private cloud environment using Linux virtualization, network segmentation, and self-hosted services to replicate enterprise infrastructure patterns, including multiple isolated Linux GUI desktop VMs running in parallel as an alternative to traditional single-OS desktop computing
- Provisioned a dedicated VM as a local file server, providing private cloud storage independent of third-party hosting, alongside additional VMs for experimental and testing workloads
- Applied VM-level sandboxing as a deliberate security and risk-containment strategy, isolating the host system from configuration errors, failed installations, and exposure during hands-on learning
- Selected and optimized hardware for performance, reliability, and cost efficiency; implemented isolated virtual environments for testing and development
- Configured physical and virtual network routing with emphasis on security, segmentation, and performance optimization

TECHNICAL TRAINING

San Diego College of Continuing Education

2012 – 2020

Coursework: Cybersecurity, Linux Administration, Python Programming, Cisco Networking, MySQL Administration, Web Server Security, Virtual Datacenter Administration

A Cloud Guru (formerly Linux Academy)

2017 – 2019

Training: AWS Fundamentals, Linux System Administration, Systemd Administration, Kali Linux, Red Hat Systems Administration

Cisco Live – Dream Team

2015

Competitively selected from the Cisco Networking Academy student body for a week-long paid deployment supporting the Cisco Live Network Operation Center across 2,500,000 sq. ft. of convention and hotel space serving thousands of attendees.

- Received hands-on training from NOC engineers and Networking Academy instructors on enterprise network topology and connected equipment function
- Applied classroom networking knowledge in a live production environment, coordinating within deployment teams installing wireless access points and CAT5e infrastructure throughout the San Diego Convention Center and adjacent hotels
- Gained direct exposure to supporting live enterprise network operations and post-event infrastructure breakdown under the supervision of senior Cisco engineers
- Earned accolades for excellent team performance and near-flawless network rollout and operation